

Anywhere Data

From the smallest to the biggest, slowest to the fastest, inside and outside, we've got all the hard disks for you to choose from

Jayesh Limaye and Sumedh Phalak

We'll repeat ourselves just this once: your hard disk is the most important component of your computer because it holds your data and is therefore, in a sense, irreplaceable. With that out of the way, we're sure you won't mind yet another hard drive shootout—with all the data you've been hoarding, you probably need one!

We don't need to introduce you to internal drives—everyone knows they're the *de facto* storage component, and everyone has one (or two, or three). External hard drives are designed primarily to be backup devices. But the smaller ones are also useful for carrying around and exchanging data with friends. Many of the prominent internal drive manufacturers are into the external drive market as well—an indicator of the increasing popularity of such devices.

This shootout is a comparison test of internal as well as external hard drive solutions.

We scoured the markets to bring you most of the available models of both these worlds, from the smallest (74 GB) to the biggest (1 TB). We've brought you 21 internal SATA hard drives and 13 external hard drives. We passed them through our all-new, rigorous battery of tests, and an analysis of their performance and features follows.

INTERNAL SATA HARD DRIVES

We have only included SATA hard drives this time, sidelining IDE completely. IDE will live on for at least a couple of years more, but we want to present you the ground reality: SATA is in,

